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17 Reverse the work and hold it by expanding the chuck jaws into the recess that was formed for the lid. Using a small gouge, complete the underside, forming a small point which will tip the box sideways. This finishes the box bottom, which is sanded and sealed ready for buffing later

18 The box lid is made in a similar way, taking care when cutting the spigot to fit the box bottom. The lid is hollowed as before and can be reversed in the jaws and gripped gently by the spigot, using tape to protect it if necessary, while the upper surface is completed. The two parts are then combined into the finished box

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The 'cooling tower' box

19 Driving past power stations I've always been struck by the elegant shape of the cooling towers, and have made many boxes based on this design. The addition of beads at the joint between lid and box, and on the top of the lid, give it just the right amount of decoration. Starting with a suitably sized blank, form a cylinder of 65mm diameter and about 75mm long with a dovetail spigot on each end. Mark the division between body and lid and part the lid section off, leaving the body in the chuck. Form the bead around the top edge, hollow the box body and cut a recess to accept the lid. None of the dimensions are critical, but refer to the diagram for guidance. Note the shape of the interior of the box. A smooth curve is easier to shape than sharp corners and has the added advantage that it makes small items easier to get out of the box

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20 Repeat this process for the lid, forming a spigot that is a tight fit in the box body. Replace the body and insert the lid. If the fit is tight the lid can be worked on without coming loose. If it won't stay put, hold it directly in the chuck, gripping the spigot in the jaws and using tape to protect the spigot if necessary. Turn the top of the lid smooth and level and form the bead on the outer edge

21 With a small gouge, shape the lid top and edge down to the bottom of the beads, adding extra beads if desired. In the same way, shape the side of the box down to meet the bottom of the lower bead

22 Examine the profile and ensure that the curve of the sides is continuous from the body through the beads into the lid. Part off the box body and reverse it, holding it with the chuck jaws expanded into the lid recess. Clean up the bottom of the box with a small gouge, then sand, seal and polish and the job's done

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23 The set of finished boxes should look something like this ●

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